

Make IT STEM - Future Suggestions

Prepared 1 July 2026. A prioritised list of improvements to consider.

Highest impact

1. Finish the Gift -> Mailchimp loop (in progress)

Until this is live, the free-gift funnel is broken from the visitor side: they submit their email but nothing arrives. This is the #1 thing to close out. Once done, every signup also joins your email list - the asset that feeds everything else.

2. Watch the Formsfree ceiling

The contact form, reviews, workshop waitlist, course waitlist AND the gift all share ONE free Formsfree form (~50 submissions/month total). If the gift takes off, real client enquiries could silently bounce. Moving the gift to Mailchimp offloads the biggest volume driver. Consider a second form for the waitlists too.

3. Write real blog posts

The blog is the single best long-term growth lever - the only part of the site that pulls in new strangers from Google. Placeholder cards do not rank. Even one genuine post a month (repurpose MentorMeet articles and LinkedIn posts) compounds over a year. Everything else converts people who already found you; the blog is what finds them.

Quick wins (low effort, real value)

4. SEO plumbing

Add a sitemap.xml and robots.txt. Ten minutes, helps Google index all the new pages properly.

5. Cookie consent banner

Google Analytics is installed and you are UK-based / GDPR-conscious, but there is no consent banner. UK PECR technically requires opt-in for analytics cookies. A small banner covers this.

6. Analytics events

GA currently only tracks page views. Adding events for form submits and "Book a Free Call" clicks tells you what is actually converting. Otherwise you are flying blind on what works.

Longer-term / worth considering

7. The maintainability problem

Every nav or footer tweak currently means editing 8-10 files by hand - slow and fragile. Cheapest first: a tiny build script that stamps a shared header/footer into each page, or move to a lightweight static generator (Astro / Eleventy). Not urgent, but it will keep biting as the site grows.

8. Loose ends from earlier

- The testimonial role labels you wanted to verify before publishing.
- Profile.pdf (your CV) is still committed publicly in the repo - remove it if that was not intentional.